

YOUR PASSION

I start with passion because if you don't have this, you will never succeed. It is a necessary condition (you must have it) but not a sufficient one (you need other things, too). Without passion, when you hit those tough times—and you will, without question—you will not be able to fight through.

By definition, a startup is about doing something that has never been done before. You are experimenting every day in new terrain, and you and your team will be way out of your comfort zone. You and they must be. It is all so new. You hope to succeed, but you will fail, in ways big and small, and often. Failed experiments are part of the startup experience. Just like in sports, where no great player has ever made all the shots he takes nor won every game she plays, you will do a lot of things that don't work right away, or don't work at all. You have to have a passion to fight through these temporary setbacks.

Passion Checklist

	I understand that...	Yes	No
1	Founding a company will be really, really hard and I still want to do it.		
2	It will be a lengthy process loaded with humiliating failures along the way, and I must learn from them and not take them personally.		
3	I cannot do it alone.		
4	The path to success is not an algorithm with set rules to follow, but an iterative process where I can only increase or decrease the odds of success, but I cannot guarantee anything. Even if I achieve success, it is only temporary.		
5	The goal is to make an "anti-fragile" organization—one that gets stronger over time when faced with problems, failures, uncertainty, and surprises.		
6	When others provide advice, I will listen, but I will also recognize that it is up to me to choose which advice to implement, and how to implement it, since only I own the final results and accountability.		
7	I will have to leave my comfort zone every day to grow and continue to be successful.		
8	I am doing this for more than the money. I believe in my cause and my team.		

[illegible]

Idea/Technology Brainstorming Notes

Use this chart to help identify your team's knowledge, skills, and interests, which can help you come up with market pull (or tech push) ideas.

Knowledge: What was the focus of your education/career?	
Capabilities: What are you most proficient at?	
Connections: Who do you know with expertise in different industries? Do you know other entrepreneurs?	
Financial assets: Do you have access to significant financial capital, or will you be relying on personal savings to start?	
Past work/life experience: In previous jobs you've held, or in previous experiences in your life, what inefficiencies or "pain points" existed?	
Passion for a particular market: Do you want to improve healthcare? Education? Energy? Transportation?	

Market Pull Mini-Canvas

1. WHAT: What is the general problem we are trying to solve or the opportunity we are looking to capitalize on?	2. URGENCY: This is a: (circle one) • Vitamin pill (i.e., nice to have) • Pain killer (i.e., solves a critical problem) • Game changer (i.e., opens new market opportunities)
3. WHY US: Our team has or would have the following assets that would make us uniquely qualified to implement this idea:	4. PASSION: Summarize why our team cares so much about this idea that we are willing to embark on this arduous & humbling journey:

Technology Push Mini-Canvas

1. WHAT: Description of the invention/technology:	2. WHY US: Why we have a significant advantage over anyone else with regard to this invention:
3. LEAP FORWARD: Compared with the most relevant current alternative, why is it so compelling that it will make people and industries change:	4. PASSION: Summarize why our team cares so much about this idea that we are willing to embark on this arduous and humbling journey: